

Cardiovascular Disease and Hypertension

Cardiovascular disease includes conditions of the heart and the arteries. Hypertension is a chronic condition with high blood pressure. It raises the risk of stroke and of myocardial infarction. Atherosclerosis forms plaque in the vessels and narrows the arteries.

Screening in primary care measures blood pressure and cholesterol. Lifestyle and drugs can treat hypertension. Beta blockers and other therapy reduce cardiac risk in many patients. Severe hypertension may require hospital care.

Imaging of the heart and the vessels helps diagnosis. The physician uses the results together with symptoms such as pain and fever. An acute infarction is a surgical and medical emergency. Recovery depends on the time to treatment and on complications.

Epidemiology studies a population and a cohort. Statistically significant results show that prevention is more effective than late treatment. Public health programs therefore describe diet, screening, and early therapy.

The mechanism of disease includes inflammation of the vessel wall. Inflammatory cells and proteins take part in plaque growth. This pathway is a target for new drugs in modern medicine.